5.3.2 Suppressing the source document

There may be instances where a document is loaded with hundreds of fields: for example, a full tweet (from the Twitter API) consists of more than just a tweet—it has dozens of attributes such as the tweet, author, timestamps, conversations, attachments, and so on. When retrieving data from Elasticsearch, sometimes we don't want to look at the source data at all—we want to suppress the source data completely and just return the metadata associated with the response. In that case, we can set the `_source` field to `false` as the request parameter in our query.

Listing 5.13 Suppressing the original source data

```
GET movies/_doc/1?_source=false
```

The response to this query is shown in figure 5.10. The command sets the `_source` flag to `false`, indicating to the server not to return the original document. As you can see from the response, only the metadata is returned, not the source document. Not fetching the original document also frees up bandwidth.

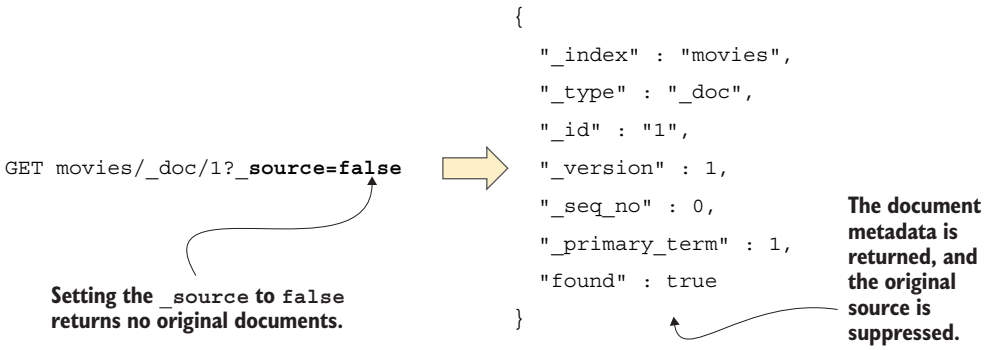


Figure 5.10 Returning metadata only

We now know how to avoid getting the whole document back, but how about returning a document with selective (inclusive or exclusive) fields? For example, we may want the `title` and `rating` of a movie to be returned, but not the `synopsis`. How can we customize what fields are included or excluded in the return list? We see how to do that in the next section.

5.3.3 Including and excluding fields

In addition to suppressing the `_source` field, we can include and/or exclude fields when retrieving documents. This is done using the `_source_includes` and `_source_excludes` parameters, similar to the `_source` parameter we used previously. We can provide the `_source_includes` attribute with a comma-separated list of fields we want